frequent in 1989. By 1990, Kashmir was in the throes of an all-out insurgency against Indian rule, forcing India to dissolve the Kashmiri state assembly and place the territory under governor's rule.[30]

The Kashmir insurgency was an indigenous phenomenon that resulted largely from Indian misrule in the region; Pakistan did not create the insurgency. The Pakistanis, however, were quick to take advantage of the opportunity that the Kashmiri uprising created for them. Pakistan began actively supporting the militancy, providing anti-Indian forces with training, arms, and infiltration and exfiltration across the line of control. This soon became a central element of Pakistani foreign policy and had a profound impact on the insurgency. It also inflicted substantial costs on India. The Pakistanis' strategy enabled them to threaten India's hold on Kashmir and attrit Indian resources. And it led India to implement draconian counterinsurgency measures that have damaged its international reputation. Approximately ninety thousand people have died in the insurgency, and despite recent improvements in the Kashmiri security situation, hundreds of thousands of Indian troops remain deployed in the region.[31] The Kashmir dispute had already given rise to periodic Indo-Pakistani conflicts. With the eruption of the insurgency, it also became an ongoing proxy war between India and Pakistan-backed forces.

The Indo-Pakistani relationship has thus been characterized by severe historical animosity dating from the founding of the two countries, numerous wars, and a festering territorial dispute that since the late 1980s has driven a low-intensity conflict between Indian forces and Pakistan-backed militants. Given this turbulent background, the international community found the notion of India and Pakistan acquiring nuclear weapons extremely worrisome.

The second reason for international concern over the possibility of nuclear proliferation in South Asia was that India and Pakistan pointedly refused to renounce their right to acquire nuclear weapons. During the 1960s, the United States, the Soviet Union, Britain, France, and China became deeply worried by the possibility that countries beyond their small group might acquire nuclear weapons. They created an international nonproliferation regime to prevent this from occurring. The centerpiece of the regime was the 1968 Non-